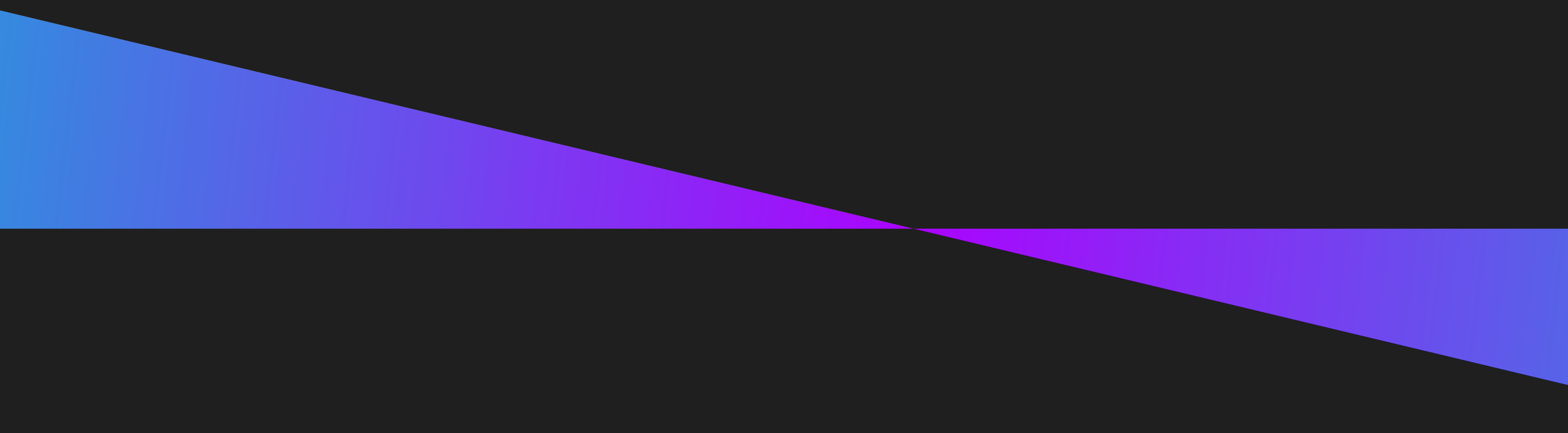


Building for Everyone: A Design Approach to Accessible Product Development.

Under the Act of the European Union

The bottom of the slide features a dark grey background with two overlapping geometric shapes. On the left, a blue triangle points downwards towards the center. On the right, a purple triangle points upwards towards the center. These two triangles overlap in the middle, creating a darker purple triangular area.

User

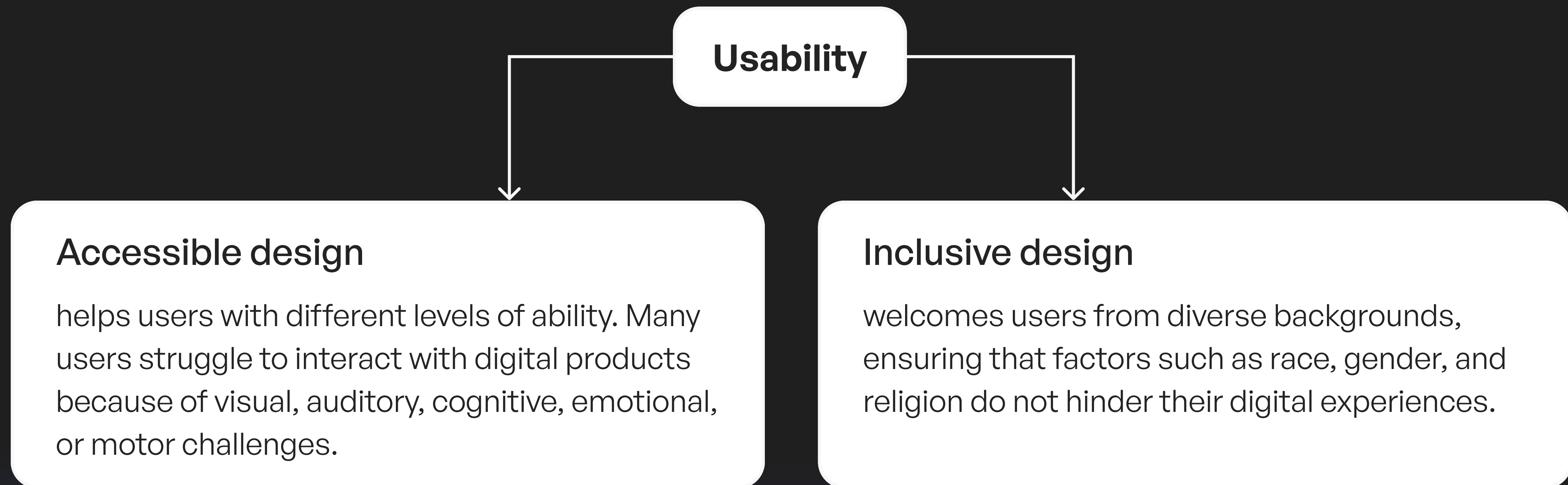
Each user is unique. Digital products should be accessible and inclusive not only because it is the right thing to do but also because it makes good business sense. An estimated 15-20% of the world's population live with a disability of some kind, and an estimated 15-20% of the world is neurodiverse (unique ways people's brains work). We cannot afford to exclude these users from our target markets.



Usability

Accessibility and inclusivity are branches of usability. They are mindsets rather than collections of procedures, regulations, or checklists.

Video about Accessibility : <https://youtu.be/20SHvU2PKsM>



Products and Services

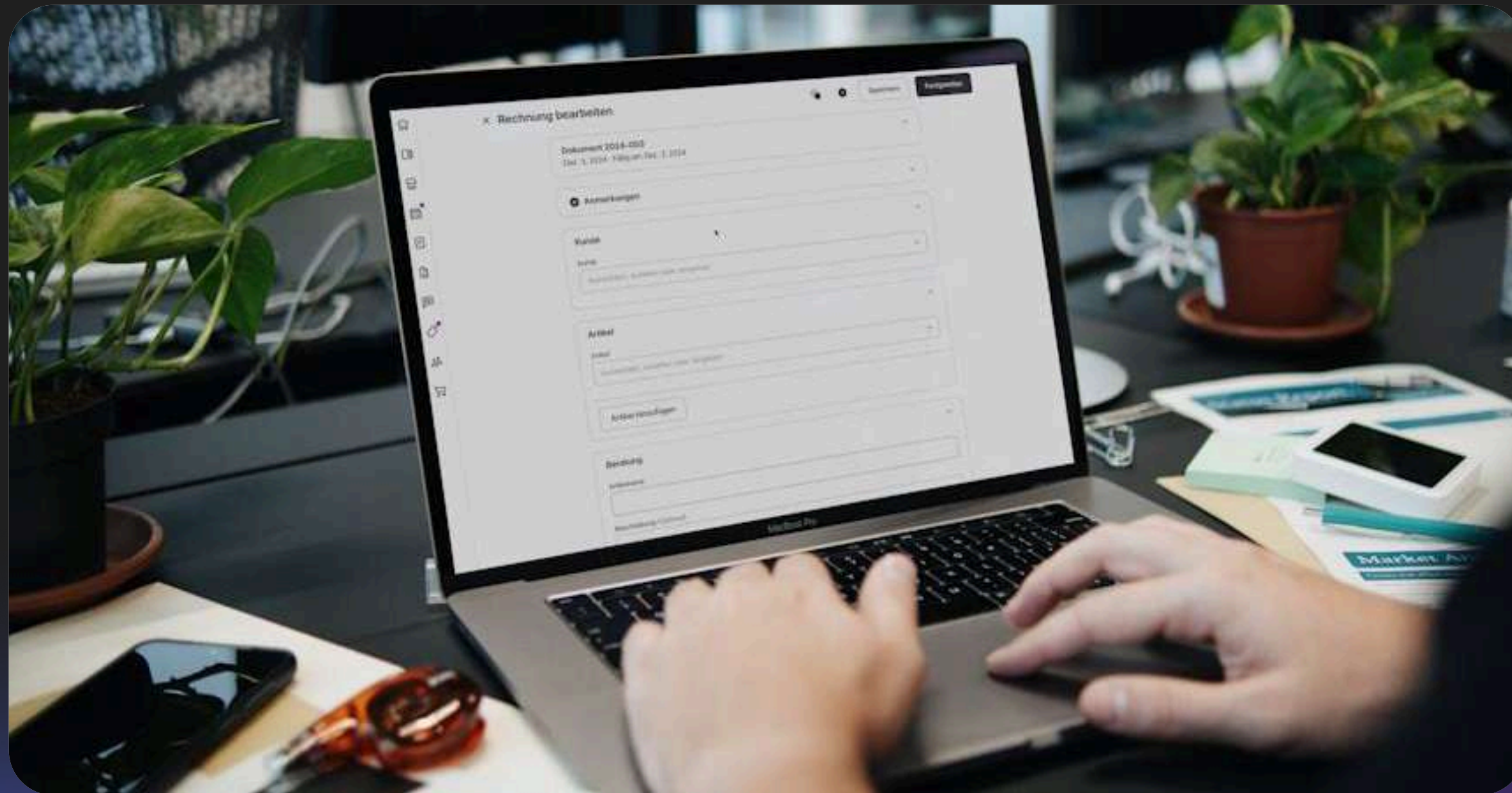
The European Accessibility Act (EAA) covers essential products and services for persons with disabilities, addressing varying accessibility standards across the EU. These include:

- E-commerce
- Computers and operating systems
- ATMs, ticketing and check-in machines
- Smartphones
- TV equipment related to digital television services
- Telephony services and related equipment
- Access to audio-visual media services such as television broadcast and related consumer equipment
- Services related to air, bus, rail and waterborne passenger transport
- Banking services
- E-books



EAA (European Accessibility Act) Compliance Guide

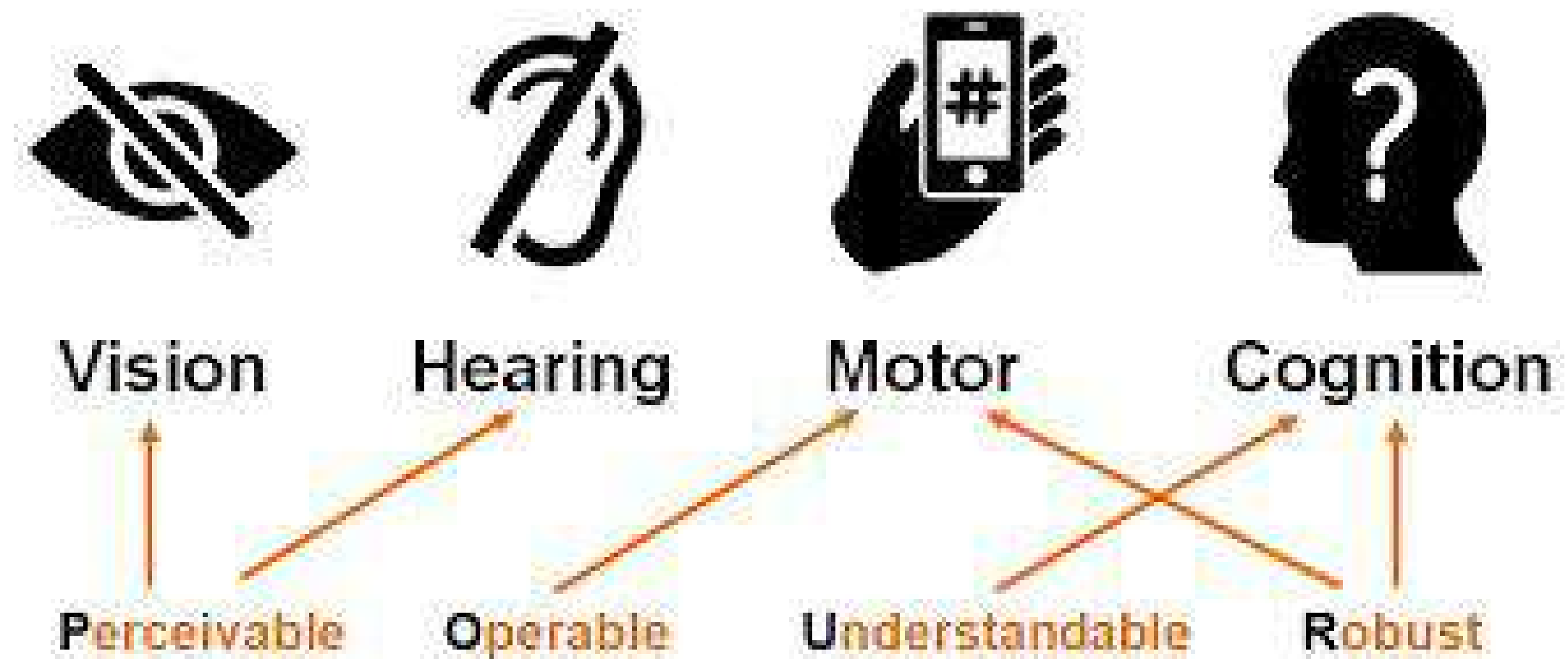
- Follow WCAG 2.1 AA standards.
- Ensure all content is must be a POUR principle



Web accessibility

POUR Principle

- Perceivable
- Operable
- Understandable
- Robust



Perceivable

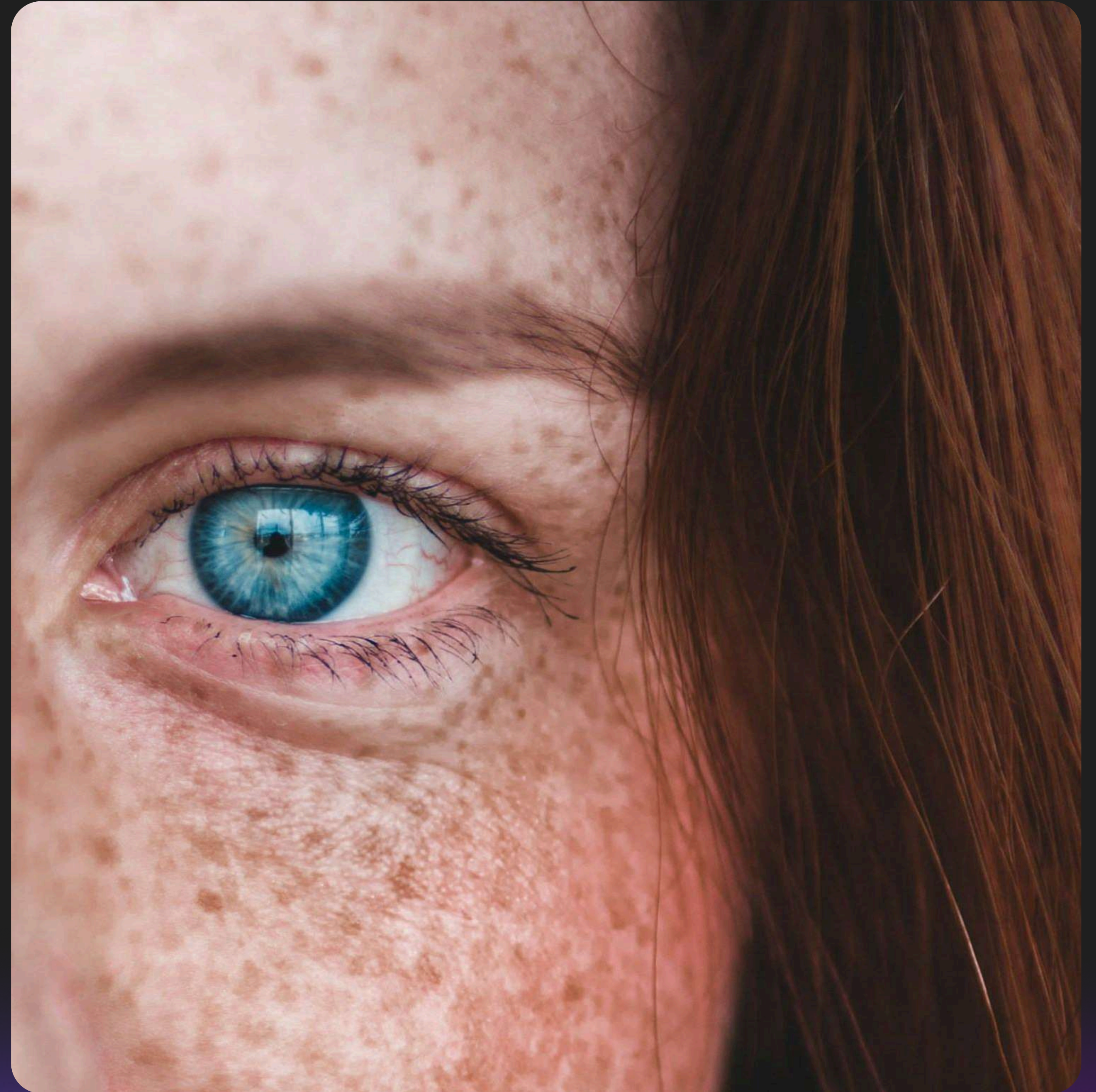
User can identify and interface elements by means of sense

Examples:

- Navigation with different link in different areas
- Non English words with screen reader use

Solution:

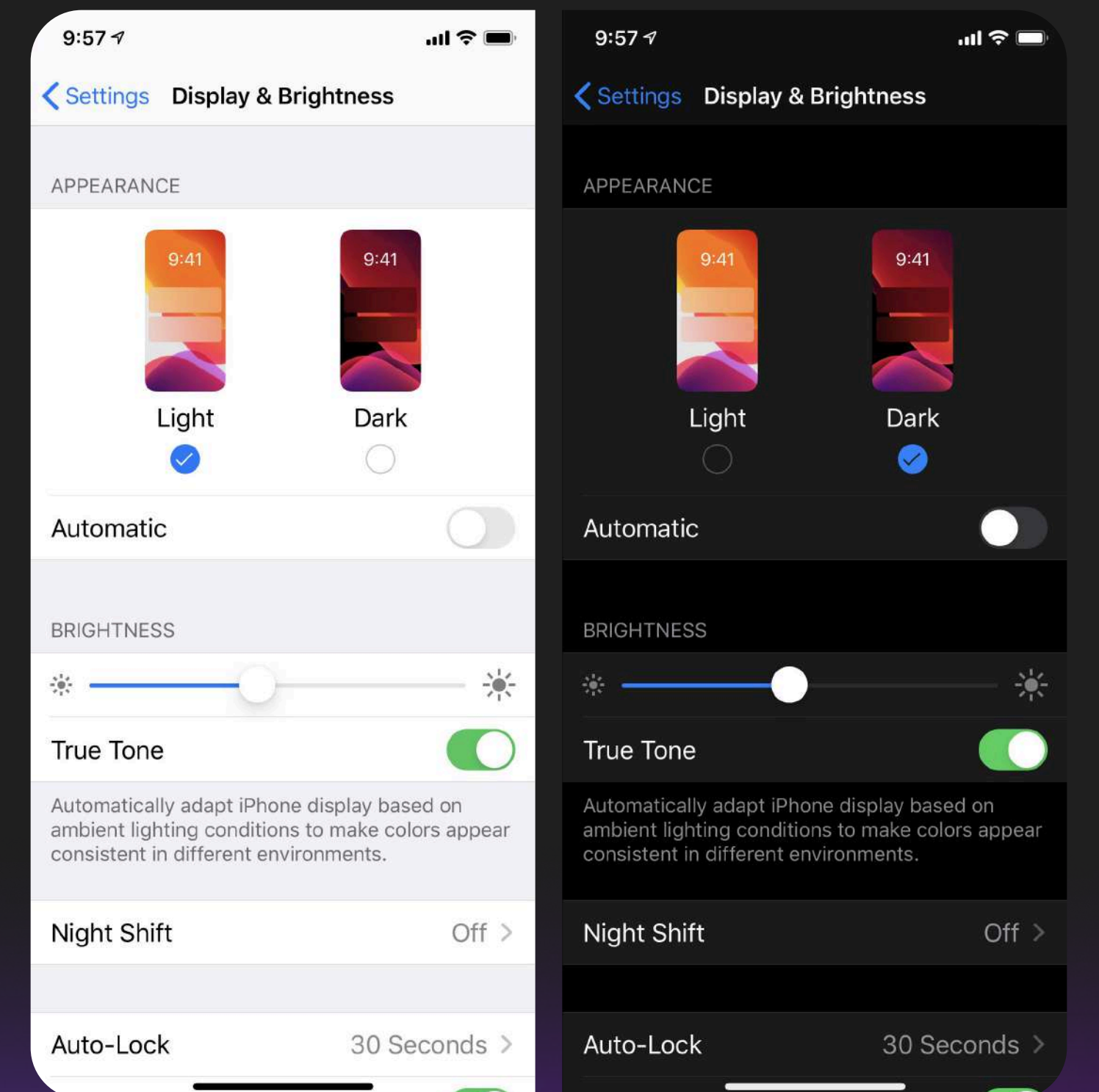
- Text alternatives
- Time based media (alternatives)
- Adaptability (different way of access)
- Distinguishable (Making things easier to see)



Perceivable

Visual Treatments (Contrast)

- Use high contrast for text and background (minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio).
- Avoid using low-contrast text to improve accessibility.
- Users with normal vision and visual impairments may perform differently in light and dark mode.
- Dark mode can improve accessibility for some users but is largely an aesthetic choice.
- Users with normal vision and visual impairments may perform differently in light and dark mode.
- Use these visual design tips to improve accessibility for users with visual impairments.



Perceivable

Visual Treatments (Typography)

- Ensure legal text is readable (use at least 16px font size).
- Use simple language and avoid complex legal jargon.

Scale Category	Typeface	Weight	Size	Case	Letter spacing
H1	Roboto	Light	96	Sentence	-1.5
H2	Roboto	Light	60	Sentence	-0.5
H3	Roboto	Regular	48	Sentence	0
H4	Roboto	Regular	34	Sentence	0.25
H5	Roboto	Regular	24	Sentence	0
H6	Roboto	Medium	20	Sentence	0.15
Subtitle 1	Roboto	Regular	16	Sentence	0.15
Subtitle 2	Roboto	Medium	14	Sentence	0.1
Body 1	Roboto	Regular	16	Sentence	0.5
Body 2	Roboto	Regular	14	Sentence	0.25
BUTTON	Roboto	Medium	14	All caps	1.25
Caption	Roboto	Regular	12	Sentence	0.4
OVERLINE	Roboto	Regular	10	All caps	1.5

Operable

User can successfully use controls, buttons, navigation and other interactive elements including with assistive technology

Examples:

Mouse only website

Solution:

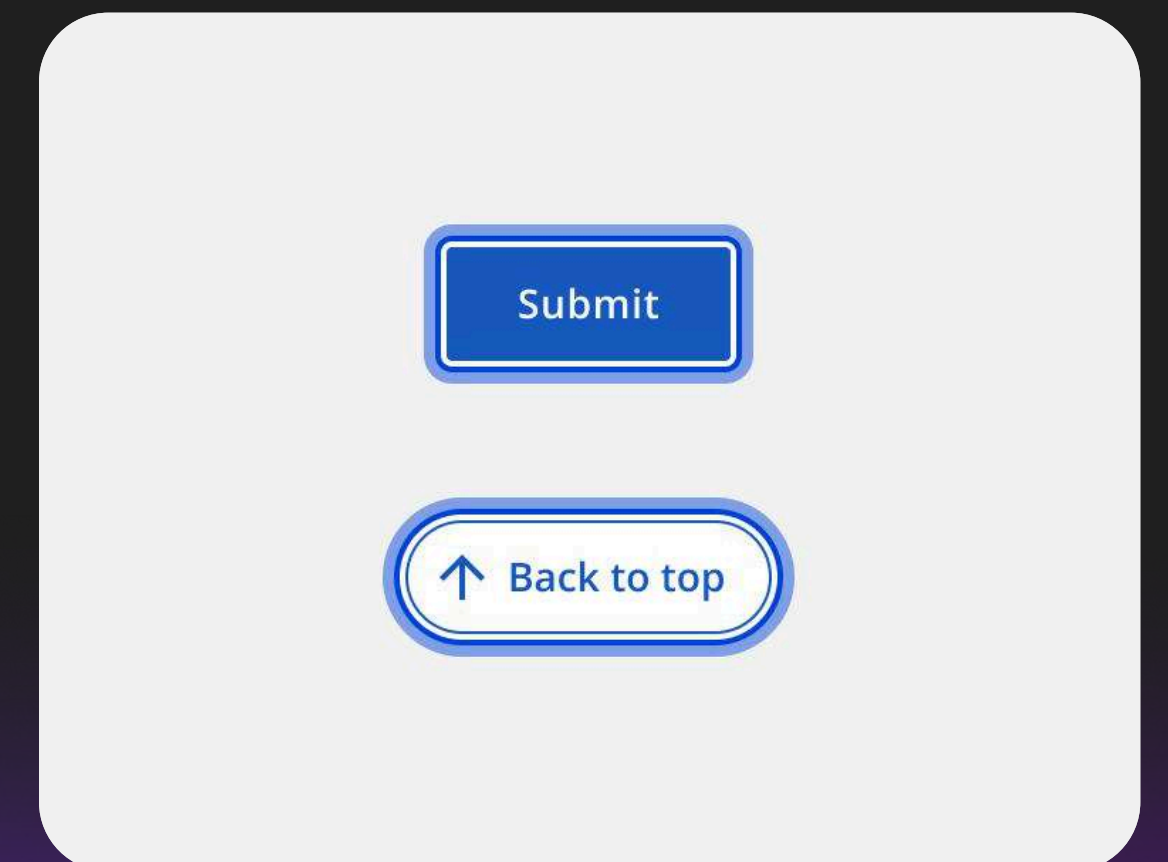
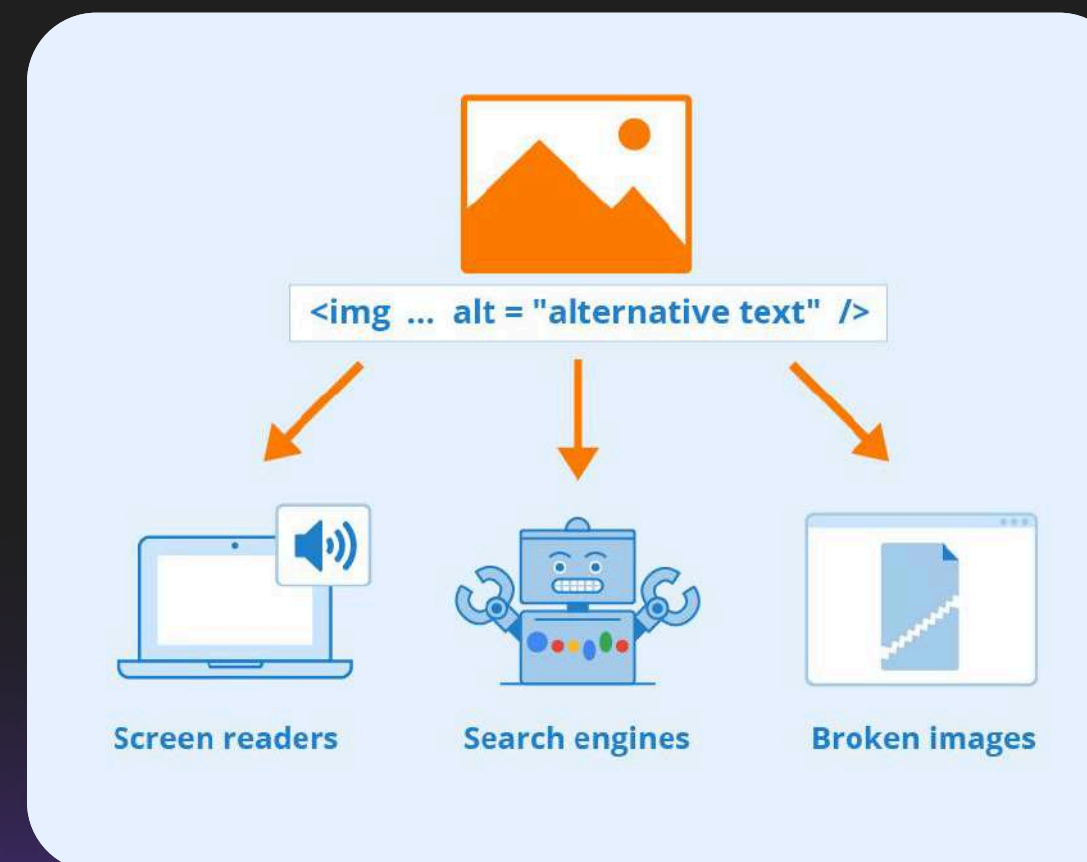
- Keyboard Accessible
- Enough Time
- Navigable
- Input Modalities



Operable

Navigation (Screen Readers)

- Include a "Skip to Main Content" link for screen readers.
- Ensure all menus can be navigated with a keyboard (Tab, Enter, Space, Arrow keys).
- Provide visible focus indicators (highlight the active element when using the keyboard).
- Alt text for all images – Describe product images meaningfully (`<img alt="Black leather wallet with RFID protection">`).
- Product information must be structured properly using headings (`<h1>`, `<h2>`).
- Ensure accessible payment options – no mouse-only interactions.
- Allow users to navigate between fields using only a keyboard.



Understandable

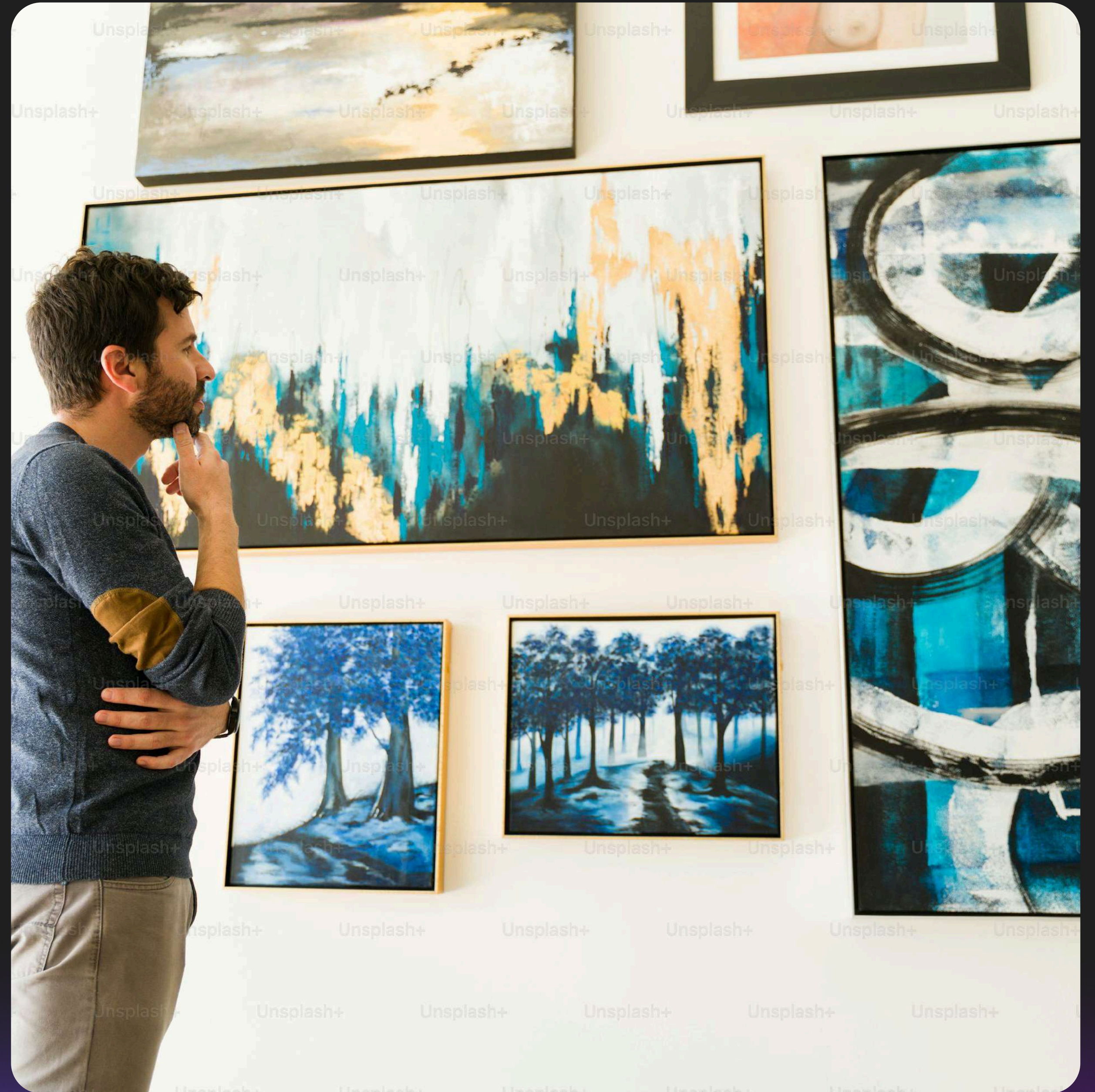
User should be able to comprehend the content and use our site

Examples:

- Navigation
- Abbreviations

Solution:

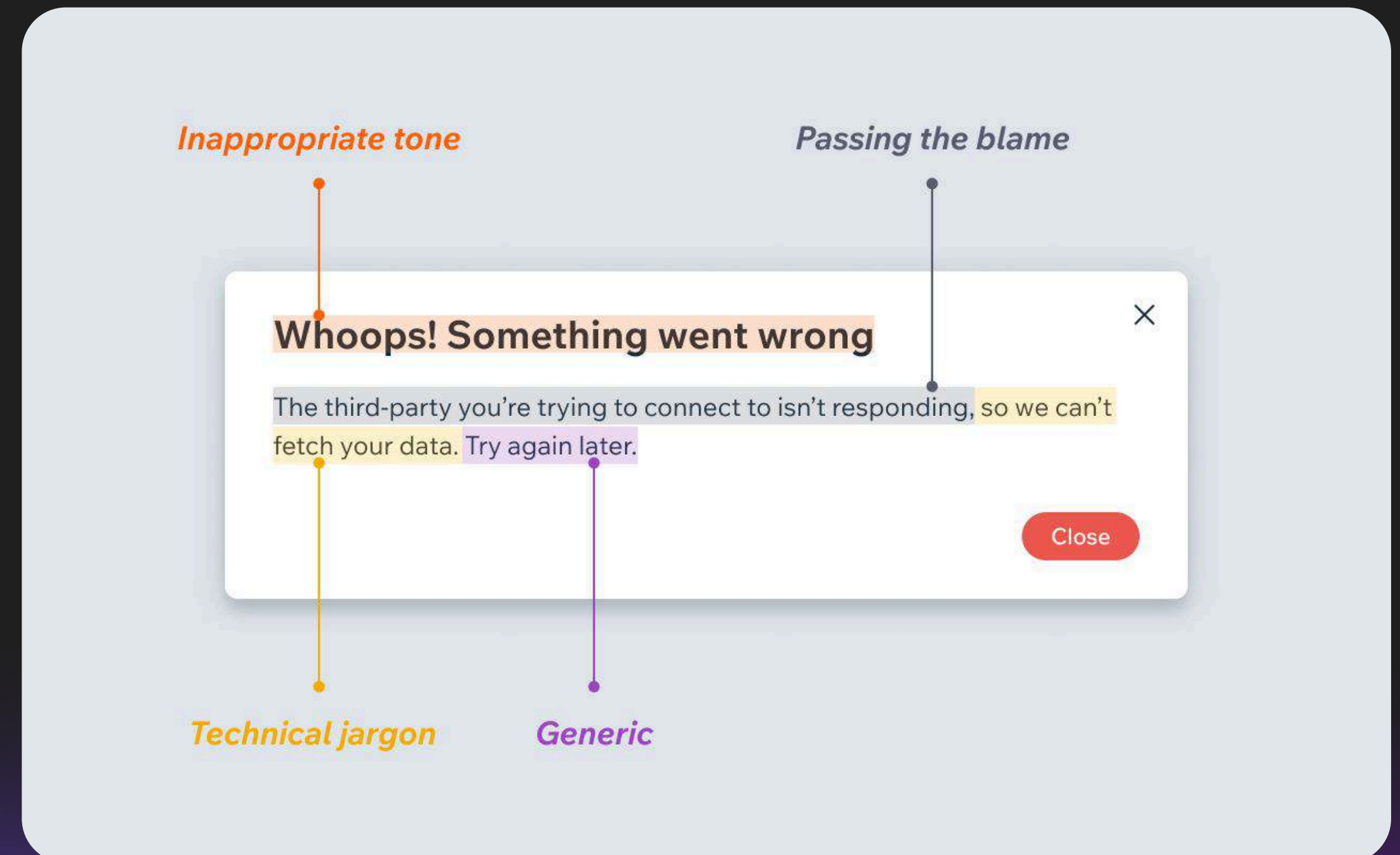
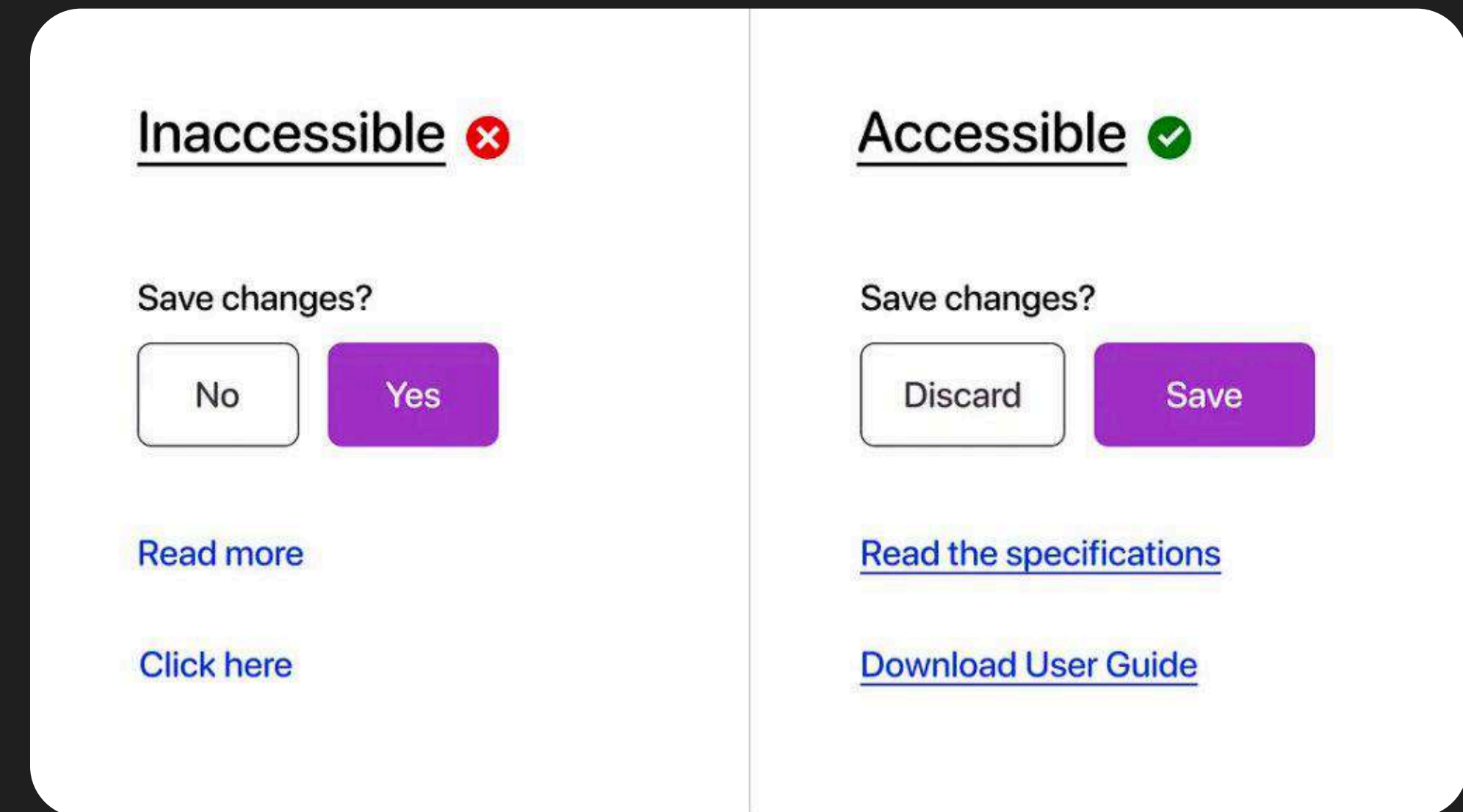
- Readable
- Predictable
- Input messages



Understandable

Feedback (Messages)

- In the world of UX, clarity is king
- Ensure all form fields have visible labels (avoid placeholders as the only label).
- Provide error messages with guidance (e.g., "Enter a valid email format").
- Avoid CAPTCHAs that require visual verification – offer alternatives like audio CAPTCHAs.
- Provide real-time feedback for incorrect card details or missing fields.



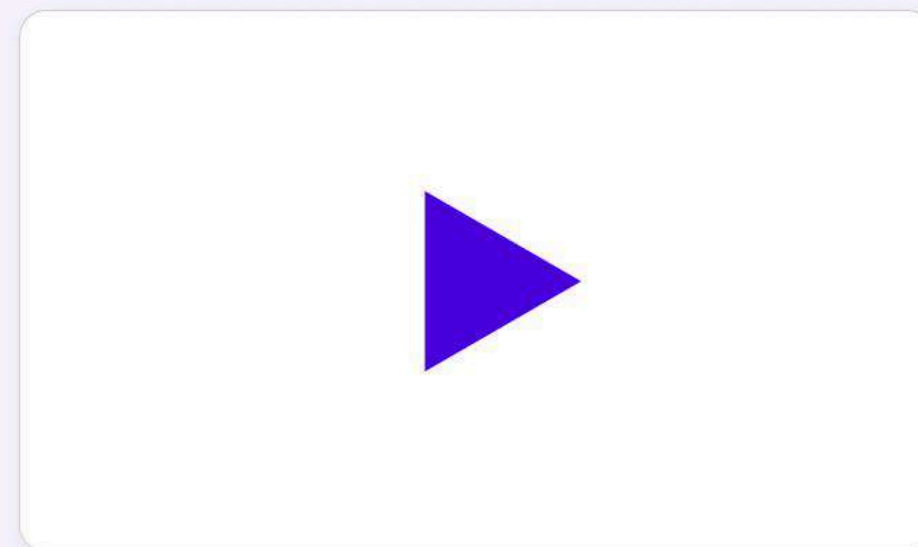
Understandable

Multimedia Content

- Multimedia isn't just for the seeing and hearing. Transcripts and captions open up your content to: Those with hearing impairments Users in sound-sensitive environments.

1.2.2 & 1.2.4 CAPTIONS

Don't forget captions!



👎 AVOID THIS



👍 TRY THIS

Robust

Content should be able to be interpreted reliably by a wide variety of users, allowing them to choose technology the use to interact with websites, online documents and multimedia

Examples:

Format inaccessible to screen readers - table with th, image with text

Solution:

Make sure Compatible with assistive technology



Robust

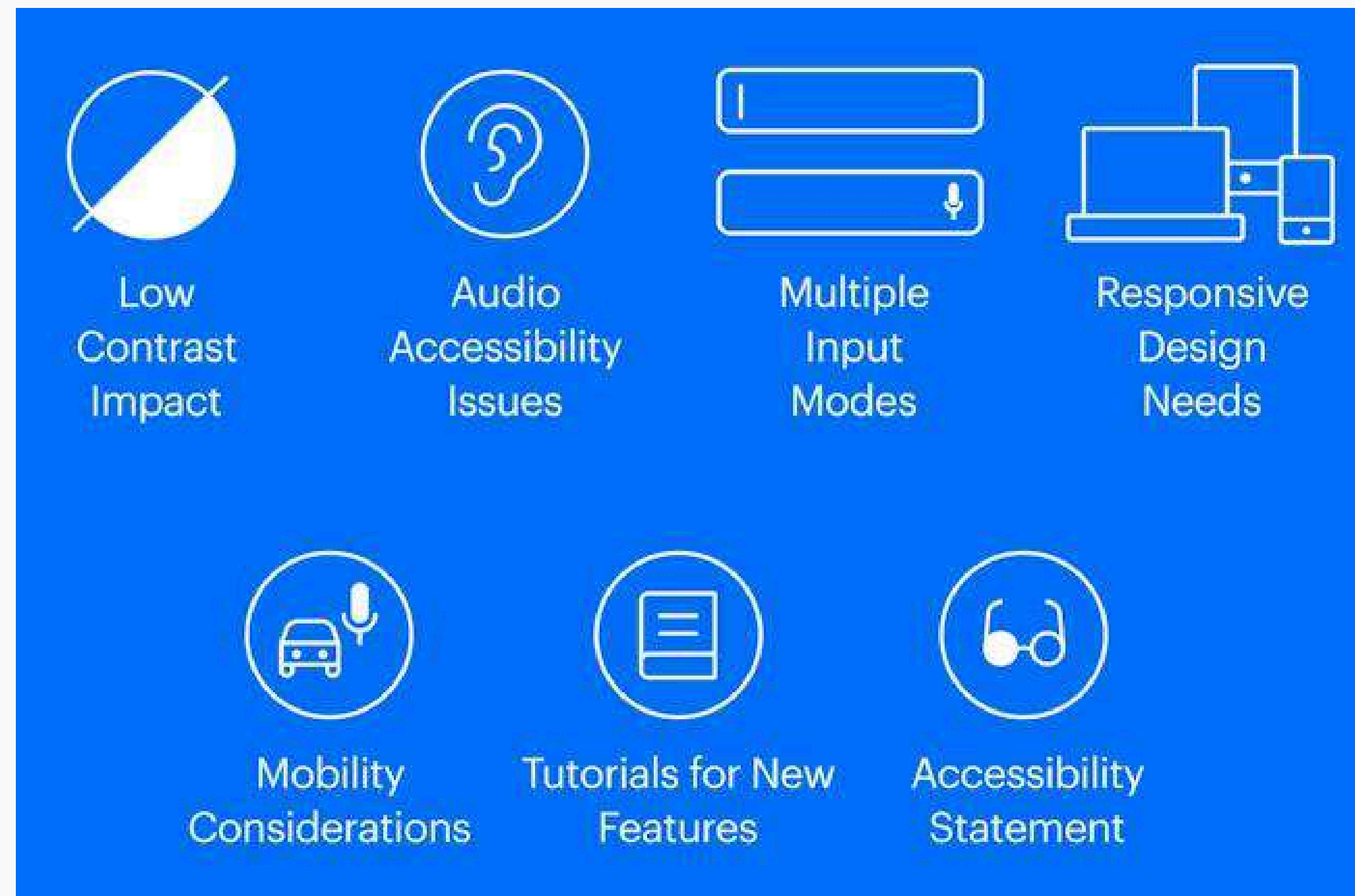
Interactions

- Animations can add life to your design, but they can also detract from it. Elements that flash or move too quickly can be problematic for users with certain disabilities.
- Search input must have a label and an accessible name (use aria-label if necessary).
- Filters should be keyboard navigable with clear focus states.
- Avoid complex dropdowns; use simple checkboxes, radio buttons, or select menus.



Common Accessibility Concerns

It is important to take a look at common accessibility concerns when designing a new product or service. Most of these are linked to the physical abilities and disabilities of the users.



Is this applicable to us?

- Generally, any business that provides relevant products or services to EU consumers must comply.¹⁶
- Microenterprises (those with fewer than 10 employees and a turnover below €2 million) are currently exempt.¹⁷
However, it is always good practice to aim for accessibility.

Consequences of Non-Compliance:

- Fines: Member states will impose penalties for non-compliance, which can be substantial.¹⁸
- Legal Action: Businesses may face lawsuits from individuals or organizations.¹⁹
- Reputational Damage: Non-compliance can negatively impact a company's reputation.

Yes!

But why?

Accessibility in digital communications is no longer an option—it's a necessity. **Starting June 28, 2025, the European Accessibility Act (EAA) will require EU businesses to ensure their products and services are accessible to individuals with disabilities.** 6 Feb 2025

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What we do

Case studies

Our thinking

ESG

Careers

level
access



There are over 80 million people with disabilities in the EU. The European Accessibility Act 2019 (EAA) implements the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with disabilities (UNCRPD) and aims at providing greater accessibility to everyday goods and services. The EEA has been implemented in Irish Law via S.I. No. 636/2023 - European Union (Accessibility Requirements of Products and Services) Regulations 2023 (Regulations). The Regulations come into effect on 28 June 2025. This article considers what financial services providers and related firms must do to ensure that retail banking products and services are more accessible to persons with disabilities. From 28 June 2025 firms will need to ensure that they design their websites, mobile apps, contracts and all forms of communication with consumers including call centre services as well as devices such as payment terminals and ATMs in a way that is accessible to persons with disabilities.

Accessibility isn't just a requirement for public-sector organizations in the European Union (EU). The European Accessibility Act (EAA) mandates that a range of products and services, including many types of online experiences such as e-commerce websites and mobile apps, are accessible to people with disabilities. The law, which applies to those doing business within the EU, aims to resolve discrepancies in accessibility requirements between different European countries.

Originally encoded into law in 2019, the EAA was adopted by individual EU nations starting in 2022. Providers of products and services covered by the EAA have until June 2025 to become compliant. A complaint process and surveillance monitoring will be established, and organizations that fail to meet these requirements may face penalties, including fines.

Reference links

- [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\) 2.1](#)
- [Video about EAA](#)
- [Video about Web Accessibility and W3C Standards](#) by WCAG
- [Article about European accessibility act](#) by EU
- [Accessibility and Inclusivity : Study guide](#) by NNG
- [Design and develop overview](#) by WCAG
- [European Accessibility Act \(EAA\)](#) by Levelaccess
- [Ireland's June 2025 deadline for making consumer banking services more accessible to persons with disabilities](#) by Hogan Lovells

Thank you